The Saturdays You Will Miss: Five Seats, Ranked

Every seat on this street pays. Nobody asks what it costs, because the cost is not quoted in hours — it is quoted in Saturdays, and it is the one line the offer letter leaves off. Five seats, counted down by the weekends you do not get back.

THE BILL, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Nobody quits over the hours. They quit over the third time they cancel on the same friend. The Saturday count is the only number that tracks it — not how late you work, but how many weekends the desk takes without asking. Your buddy gets engaged, you say yes, you book the flight, and you cancel on Thursday night. Do that three times and they stop asking. The $250k is real. So is the group chat you are not in at 32. Both are on the same offer; only one of them is printed on it.

The Countdown

Seat	Saturdays lost	What that actually looks like
5 · Wealth Management	**~4 a year**	You are at the wedding, you are in the photos, and you are still there at midnight. The only seat in finance where your friends still text you.
4 · Equity Research	**~10**	Earnings season eats a few and then gives them back. Brutal and predictable — and predictable is the entire difference, because you can plan around a calendar you can see.
3 · Structured Credit	**~15**	You go to the wedding. You leave the reception at 9:00 p.m. to check a tape. You were there, and everyone noticed the exact moment you were not.
2 · Sales & Trading	**~8 on paper**	The Saturdays are not the bill — the 4:30 a.m. start is. You are at every wedding and gone by 10:00 p.m. Technically present. The seat costs your nights, then charges the weekend anyway.
1 · Evercore / Centerview / Goldman	**40–45**	The worst spot on the board. You say yes, you book the flight, you cancel Thursday night. Three times and they stop asking. $250k is real money, but you are paying in a currency you cannot earn back.

The Backward Math

If you want this…	…you are buying it here	Which means the real price is
$250k at twenty-three	**The 40-Saturday seat**	Real money, on a two-year clock, paid in the one currency that does not accrue back.
To still be at the wedding	**Wealth management, research**	Fewer zeros on the number, and a friend group that survives your twenties intact.
Both, eventually	**Two years, then out**	Treat the seat as a tour, not an identity. The exit is the plan; staying is the drift.
The invoice nobody sends	**Age thirty-two**	A group chat you are not in. Nothing arrives to tell you — the invitations simply stop.

Saturday counts are directional estimates from prior-cycle patterns, not published or firm-reported figures. Group, desk, MD and live deal flow set the real number — an active process erases weekends in every seat on this list.

Know the bill before you sign for it.

Take the 60-second quiz and get a personalized path from your current profile to the next seat on it.

TAKE THE QUIZ → wallstalpha.com/apply

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